Snap Inc. joins the Alliance for Open Media

The Alliance for Open Media (AOMedia), a non-profit focusing on open source digital media technology to everyone, has announced that Snap Inc. has joined the organisation at the promoter level. Snap Inc., a camera company, empowers people to express themselves, live in the moment, learn about the world and have fun together. Its technologies and services, such as Snapchat and Spectacles, use video and augmented reality to enhance how their community experiences the world.

As a member of the Alliance, Snap Inc. will collaborate with AOMedia members, the leading Internet and media technology companies, to advance open standards for media compression and delivery over the Web.

AOMedia's AV1 is an open source codec that is interoperable, open, optimised for Internet delivery and scalable to any modern device at any bandwidth. AV1 enables more screens to display the vivid images, deeper colours, brighter highlights, darker shadows and other enhanced UHD imaging features that consumers and businesses have come to expect – all while using less data.

"We're very pleased to welcome Snap Inc. to the Alliance for Open Media, highlighting our joint commitment to leverage AV1 to improve streaming media in new and cutting-edge ways," said Matt Frost, AOMedia chair and director at Google. "Snap Inc. brings a wealth of interactive video experience to support the development and adoption of AV1. Using AOMedia's open framework, Snap Inc.'s knowledge and expertise will enhance our collective efforts to deliver next-generation video experiences that incorporate augmented reality video capabilities and more."

changing two lines of code. GooseAI has been released as a joint venture between CoreWeave and partner Anlatan – the creators of NovelAI.

Apache CloudStack enables digital services across India

The open source Apache CloudStack infrastructure-as-a-service (IaaS) platform is helping India's 1.38 billion citizens gain access to government services. The country's topography and population density, with citizens residing in huge cities and outlying villages, make it difficult to bring digital services to India's population. Abhishek Ranjan, chief technology officer of CSC e-Governance Services India, spoke at the CloudStack Collaboration Conference 2021 about how the open source cloud platform is helping to bring government services to even the most rural parts of India.

To that end, CSCs (Common Service Centres), a government of India initiative under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, are setting up digital kiosks and government services offices across the country to provide individuals with access to a variety of services. Citizens can use government health, banking, insurance, and communications services as a result of this endeavour.

CSC considered using a public cloud provider like Amazon Web Services or Microsoft Azure, but finally determined that building its own cloud was the best option, according to Ranjan. Because of the necessity for extremely precise controls and the jurisdictional requirements in India, CSC's only alternative was to construct and run its own cloud, as public cloud providers just did not have the capabilities to fulfil its needs.

The CSC team investigated various choices before settling on the Apache CloudStack project. Since 2012, CloudStack has been an Apache Software Foundation open source project.

According to Ranjan, CSC began by testing with CloudStack on a single server to learn how to install it. The system's ease of use and simplicity provided him and his team the confidence they needed to expand the deployment. That first deployment took place in 2016, and Ranjan's faith in CloudStack has only grown over the subsequent years.

CSC develops application services for India's citizens using the open source Apache CloudStack cloud base. The open source KVM hypervisor and the free source Ceph object storage technology are the key virtualisation technologies used by CSC in CloudStack. Logs and application monitoring are handled by Elastic Stack, while automation is handled by Ansible.

For more news, visit *www.opensourceforu.com*